

KING FAHAD CENTRAL HOSPITAL / STROKE PROGRAM

STROKE PROGRAM STAFF EDUCATION POLICY

Document Code: SU-015-DOC-01	Version: 1.0
Parent Policy: SU-015 - Nursing and Staff Stroke Education Program	Master Manual: SU-MANUAL-01

Staff Education, Orientation & Competency Management – Stroke Program

Policy Title:	Stroke Program Staff Education and Competency Policy
Department:	Stroke Program
Effective Date:	<i>Click or tap to enter a date.</i>
Review Date:	<i>Click or tap to enter a date.</i>
Approved By:	Stroke Interprofessional Committee (IPC)

Purpose

To ensure that all healthcare professionals involved in the care of patients with suspected or confirmed stroke possess the knowledge and competencies required to provide evidence-based, timely, and safe stroke care in accordance with the hospital Stroke Program and current American Heart Association / American Stroke Association (AHA/ASA) clinical practice guidelines.

Scope

This policy applies to all personnel involved in stroke patient care, including:

- Emergency physicians
- Neurologists
- Internal medicine physicians
- Emergency nurses
- ICU nurses
- Stroke unit nurses
- Radiology physicians and technologists
- Laboratory personnel
- Pharmacists
- EMS personnel (where applicable)
- Physiotherapists
- Occupational therapists
- Speech-language pathologists
- Dietitians
- Case managers
- Social workers

Policy Statement

The Stroke Program shall provide structured orientation, ongoing education, competency assessment, and annual updates for all healthcare professionals involved in stroke care.

Requirements

New Staff Orientation

All newly assigned staff shall complete stroke orientation within 30 days of assignment. Orientation shall include:

- Stroke Program overview
- Stroke Code activation process
- Recognition of stroke signs and symptoms (BEFAST)
- Acute ischemic stroke pathway
- Intracerebral hemorrhage pathway
- NIH Stroke Scale (NIHSS) overview
- Door-to-CT and Door-to-Needle workflow
- Thrombolysis eligibility and contraindications
- Mechanical thrombectomy pathway
- Dysphagia screening
- Blood pressure management
- Documentation requirements
- Telestroke workflow (if applicable)
- Patient and family education
- Secondary stroke prevention

Annual Education

All stroke team members shall receive annual education covering:

- Updated AHA/ASA Stroke Guidelines
- Review of Stroke Program KPIs
- Lessons learned from quality reviews
- Mock Stroke Code participation
- Changes to protocols
- Medication safety
- Documentation standards

Competency Assessment

Competency may be evaluated through:

- Written examination
- Skills validation
- Direct observation
- Simulation exercises
- Mock Stroke Code participation
- NIHSS certification (where applicable)

Documentation

The Stroke Program Coordinator shall maintain:

- Attendance records
- Orientation checklists
- Competency assessments
- Annual education records
- Continuing education certificates

Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Stroke Program Director	• Oversees educational strategy. • Approves annual education plan.
Stroke Coordinator	• Coordinates education sessions. • Maintains educational records. • Tracks staff compliance.
Department Managers	• Ensure staff participation. • Monitor competency completion.
Healthcare Staff	• Complete required education. • Maintain required certifications. • Participate in quality improvement activities.

STROKE PROGRAM STAFF ORIENTATION CHECKLIST

Employee Name:		Department:	
Position:		Date of Hire:	
Preceptor:		Employee ID:	

Orientation Topics

Orientation Topic	Completed	Date	Initials
Stroke Program overview	☐		
Stroke Code activation process	☐		
Recognition of stroke signs and symptoms (BEFAST)	☐		
Emergency stroke workflow	☐		
Door-to-CT process	☐		
Door-to-Needle workflow	☐		
NIH Stroke Scale (NIHSS) overview	☐		
Thrombolytic eligibility	☐		
Thrombolytic contraindications	☐		
Mechanical thrombectomy pathway	☐		
Hemorrhagic stroke management	☐		
Blood pressure management	☐		
Dysphagia screening	☐		
Glucose management	☐		
Stroke documentation requirements	☐		
Telestroke process (if applicable)	☐		
Patient and family education requirements	☐		
Secondary stroke prevention	☐		
Rehabilitation referral process	☐		
Stroke quality indicators (KPIs)	☐		
Mock Stroke Code participation	☐		
Review of stroke protocols	☐		

Competency Verification

Competency	Completed	Date
NIHSS Competency (required for designated staff)	☐	
Stroke Code Simulation	☐	
Written Knowledge Assessment	☐	
Direct Observation	☐	

Sign-Off

Preceptor Signature

Date

Employee Signature

Date

Stroke Coordinator Signature

Date